

CHALLENGE #22: WebDecode Write-up.

WebDecode

Easy

Web Exploitation

picoCTF 2024

browser_webshell_solvable

AUTHOR: NANA AMA ATOMBO-SACKY

Description

Do you know how to use the web inspector?
Additional details will be available after launching your challenge instance.

This challenge launches an instance on demand.
Its current status is:
NOT_RUNNING

Launch Instance

90,072 users solved

1

2

Use the web inspector on other files included by the web page.

90,072 users solved

1

2

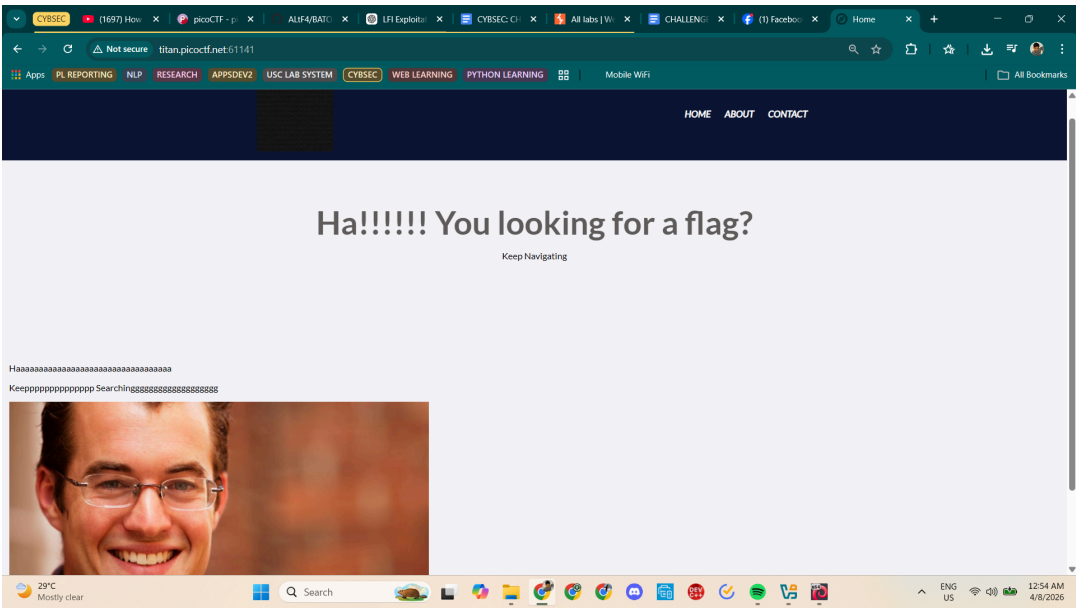
The flag may or may not be encoded

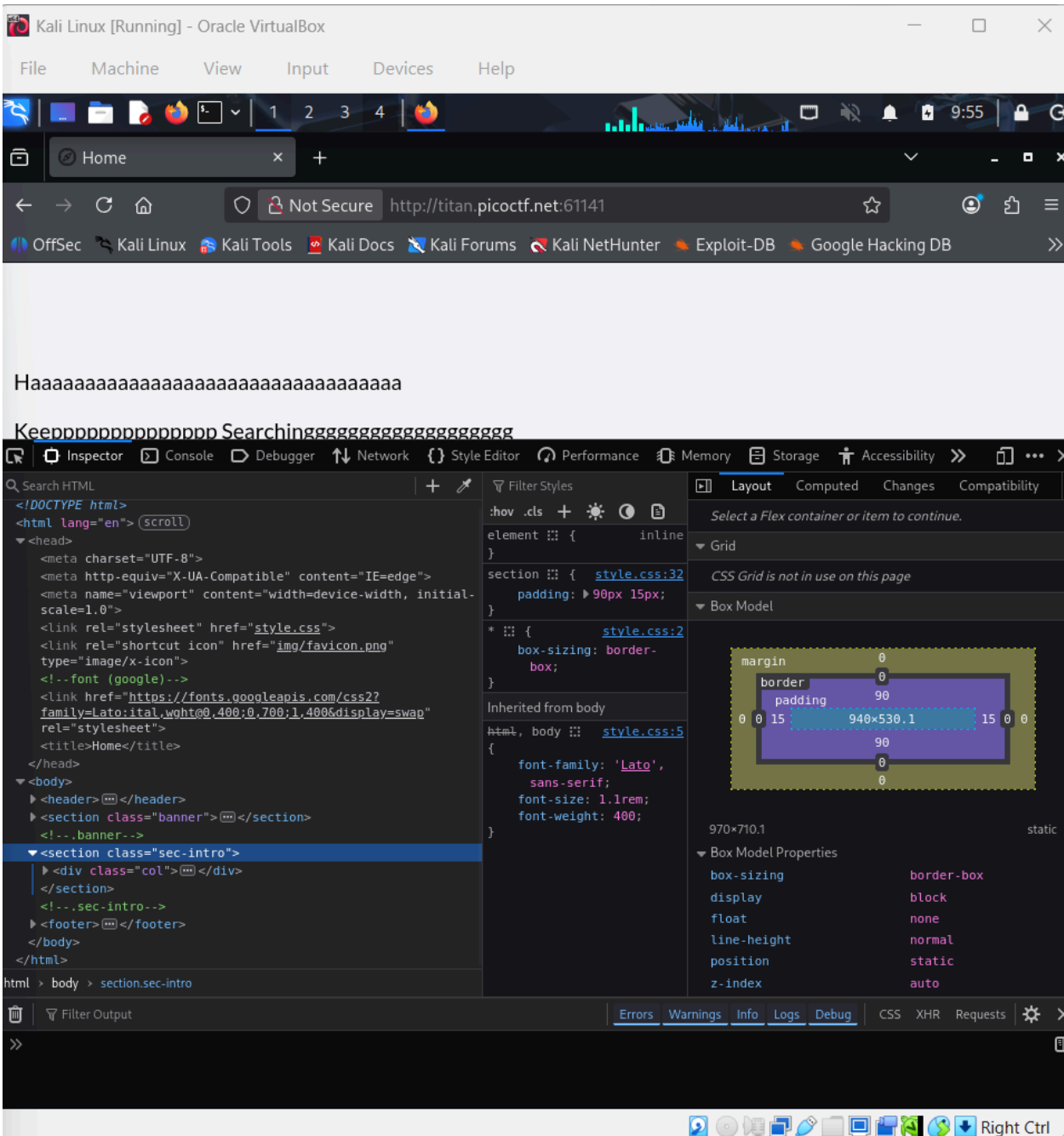
Flag

picoCTF{FLAG}

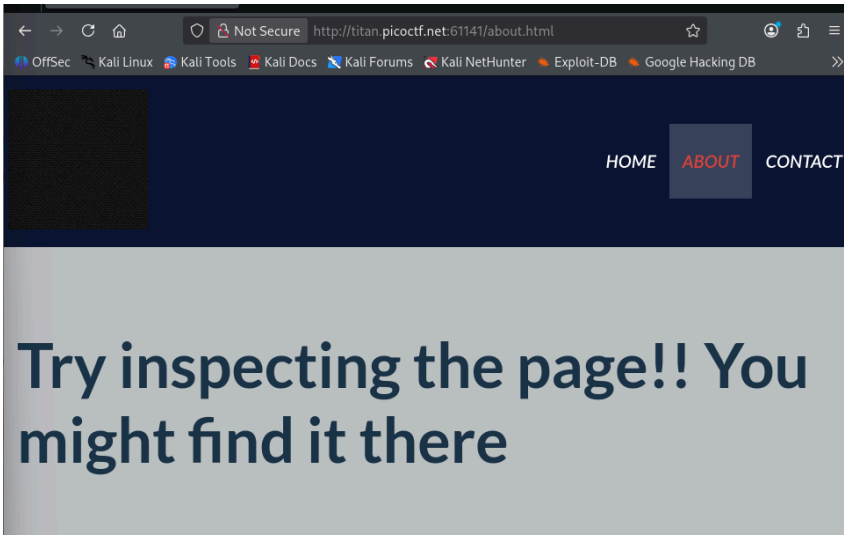
Solving Process:

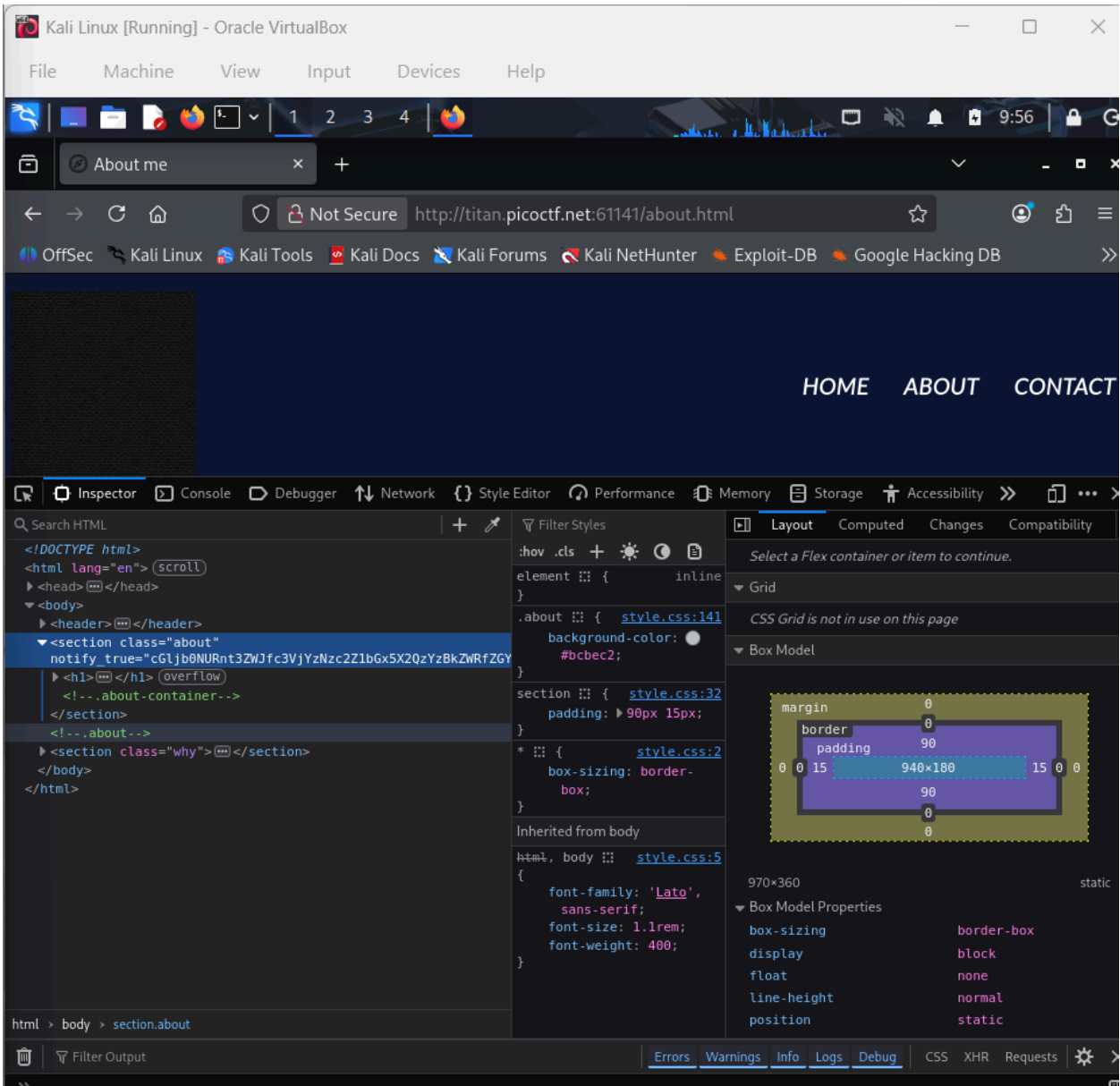
The description suggested using the **web inspector** to locate the flag. The first step was to search through the HTML code of the homepage to see if the flag was directly embedded there. However, no flag was found on the main page.



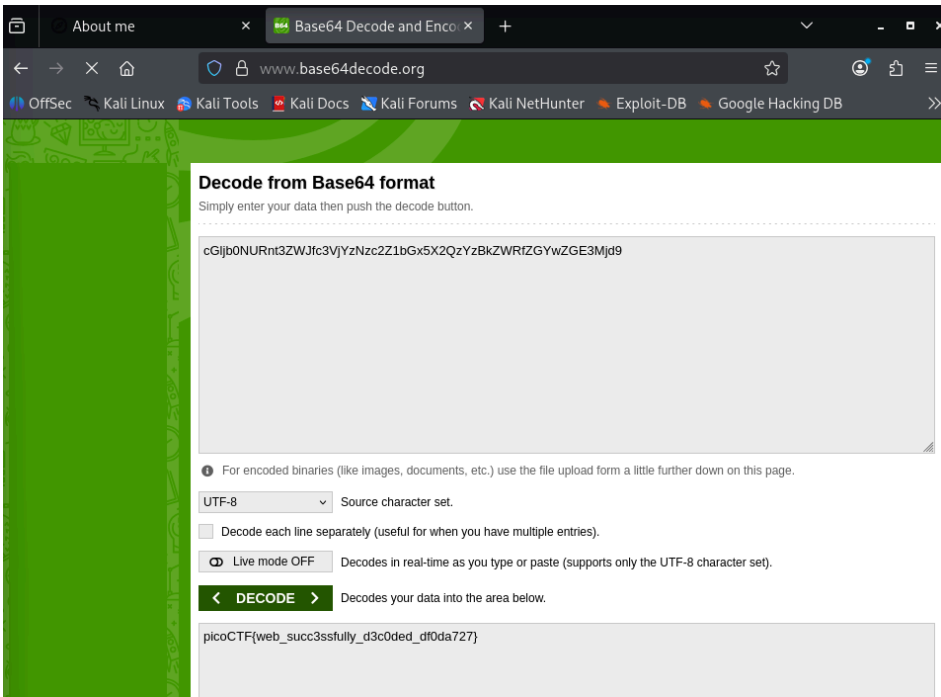


Next, the **About** page of the website was opened. The page contained a hint encouraging the user to inspect the page again. After opening the inspector on this page, an HTML element was discovered with a class labeled “**about**” and an attribute named **notify=“true”** containing a string of encoded text.





The string appeared to be Base64 encoded, which is often recognizable because it contains characters that typically end with “=” or “==”. The encoded string was copied and pasted into an online Base64 decoder. After decoding the string, the result revealed the flag.



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Description

Do you know how to use the web inspector?
Start searching [here](#) to find the flag

This challenge launches an instance on demand.
Its current status is: **RUNNING**
Instance Time Remaining: **29:11**

Restart Instance

Hints 

1

2

90,072 users solved



89%
Liked



 picoCTF{web_succ3ssfully_d3c0ded_df0da727}

Submit Flag

Hurray! You solved this challenge.



Reflection:

This challenge highlighted the importance of using browser developer tools to inspect hidden elements in a webpage. Information that is not visible on the page can sometimes still exist within the HTML attributes. The activity showed how encoded data within webpage elements can hide sensitive information if developers are not careful.